

PlayStation goes slim

So now that the new PlayStation 3 Slim has been unveiled, the question for every Indian is "When can we get our hands on it?" Well, Digit's got the exclusive details, straight from the horse's mouth!

You can expect the PS3 Slim to hit retail shelves in India in November, for around the same price as the current 80 GB 'Fat PS3', which received a

Slim some time in November," he said.

"We realise the disappointment during the festive season and have hence released the 80 GB PS3 bundle with two free titles for gaming enthusiasts," he added.

And what's more, Bose revealed that the Fat PS3 will be phased out once current stocks are sold out.

"Once the current lot of



price cut to retail at Rs. 19,990. However, while the Fat PS3 also comes bundled with two games (*Uncharted: Drake's Fortune* and *GT5 Prologue*), the PS3 Slim will carry no such packaged titles.

Atindriya Bose, Country Manager, Sony Computer Entertainment, told Think Digit: "As you know, the worldwide launch for the PS3 Slim is scheduled for September 1, and since we normally get our shipments from the European market, that usually means a delay of about a month and half."

"However, with Diwali coming up, logistics becomes a little difficult. So we are targetting a launch for the PS3

80 GB PS3 units are sold, we will be making only the 120 GB PS3 Slim available in the Indian market," he said.

So, will you wait out until November for the PS3 Slim or grab the 80 GB PS3 bundle with the two free games?

'Rozgar Duniya' - a new job portal for rural India

The idea of an online employment portal for Indian villagers does not seem quite plausible at first. But, if there are two organisations that can make it successful, they have to be Monster.com and ITC's e-Choupal initiative.

Together, they have now launched a bi-lingual (Hindi

and English) portal, Rozgar Duniya, to cater specifically to rural job seekers in India. Job categories include textiles and weaving, teaching, mechanics and auto repair, data entry and industrial jobs such as motor binding, steel fabrication, glass blowing and administration.

The biggest obstacle, obviously, is in getting the technologically backward and often illiterate farmers and other villagers to participate. This is where e-Choupal comes in.

These e-Choupals are internet kiosks in villages that offer farmers crop, weather and market information. Overall, there are 6,500 such kiosks in ten states so far, reaching four million villagers. For more information, read an interesting article at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/96904/>.

Xbox 360 failure over 50 per cent!

A consumer survey by Game Informer magazine has revealed some astounding facts, the prime among them being that one out of every two Xbox 360 units sold is malfunctioning; yet, owners will be undeterred by the hardware failure and still buy the console in the future!

The Xbox 360 has been notorious for a string of technical failures, the most widely renowned being the dreaded *Red Ring Of Death*.

The survey found that the Xbox 360 has a 54.2 per cent failure rate, compared to 10.6 per cent for the PS3 and the Wii's 6.8 per cent.

"Microsoft also seized the gold medal for unhelpful customer service, taking nearly a month to repair or replace a console, while Nintendo and Sony stuck closer to a week. Only 37.7 per cent of Microsoft customers found the company's customer service was "very helpful," compared to 51.1 per cent for Sony and



Microsoft's Big Blunder?

56.1 per cent for Nintendo," reported The Consumerist.

The most shocking number from the survey – and frightening from a consumer perspective – is that only 3.8 percent of Xbox 360 owners said they'd never buy another Xbox because of hardware failure.

Sony's fast Li-ions

Sony has announced a new line of rechargeable lithium ion cells. These batteries use olivine-type lithium ion phosphate cathodes and give a much desired combination of long life, fast recharging and good power density.

These marvels are capable of as many as 2,000 charge-discharge cycles, and if that wasn't impressive enough, they manage to retain more than 80 per cent of their capacity even after that!

The batteries will be capable of being charged up to 99 per cent of their full capacity in as little as 30 minutes – this is half that of their current batteries. Imagine the consequences this can have for mobile devices, where battery life and recharge time are especially important. For those seeking more specific details, check out <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/31392/>.